

Blizzard confirms
no LAN support for
Starcraft II

Sony might develop a phone
component to their successful
Playstation Portable handheld

Google BINGes on Caffeine

Is Google beginning to feel the competition from Bing already? In a blog post at the end of August, Google announced its "next-generation" infrastructure, dubbed Caffeine.

Competition brings out the best in products, and this is clearly an example of the benefits of competition. Like all things Google though, the Caffeine-based engine is as simple as the standard Google search. The changes made have been entirely "under the hood" and the only effect (and not even much at that) will be in the search results and speed.

Google is now looking for people to give feedback on its new venture, especially the power searchers who might actually notice a difference in the results they get. Those interested can head over to <http://www2.sandbox.google.com/> to try it out.

IBM to develop DNA microchips

Researchers at IBM's US-based laboratories and the California Institute of Technology (Caltech) have developed a new method to use DNA to create next-gen microchips that are faster, cheaper and more energy efficient.

Artificial DNA nanostructures, or "DNA

origami" may provide a cheap framework on which to build tiny microchips, according to a paper published on Sunday in the journal Nature Nanotechnology. This means that such DNA molecules can be used as scaffolds (mini circuit boards) for carbon nanotubes, nanowires and nanoparticles to assemble themselves into precise patterns.

"This is the first demonstration of using biological molecules to help with processing in the semiconductor industry," IBM research



Microchips of the future?

manager Spike Narayan told Reuters. "Basically, this is telling us that biological structures like DNA actually offer some very reproducible, repetitive kinds of patterns that we can actually leverage in semiconductor processes."

The research might help manufacturers such as IBM, Intel and AMD keep up with Moore's Law, which states that the number of transistors on a circuit roughly double every two years. The biggest obstacle to keeping up with Moore's Law is developing smaller and smaller chipsets.

To read up about this, just type <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/36684/>.

ISRO launches 'Bhuvan'

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) unveiled its most ambitious people-oriented project yet. *Bhuvan*, meaning 'Earth' in Sanskrit is a remote-sensing 3D image portal that promises to take on the likes of popular virtual globe-mapping applications such as Google Earth and Wikimapia. What's more, it is technically superior on paper!

The most interesting feature for users will be the ability of Bhuvan to zoom far closer than the aerial view from a chopper. While Google Earth restricts zooming to 200 metres and Wikimapia goes up to 50 metres, ISRO's new technology will be able to render images from up to 10 metres, which means you can easily see details up to a three-floor high building and also add information.

The other important



India's answer to Google Earth

feature is that Bhuvan uses seven satellites (including ISRO's Resourcesat-1, Cartosat-1 and Cartosat-2) to provide images, as well as time-stamping for multiple views from the same satellite. This provides images from different angles apart from the default top-down perpendicular view, thus enriching the user experience.

ISRO will update images for the program once every year, compared to Google's four-year updates. As it keeps updating its database with more recent and higher resolution images, Bhuvan eventually promises to offer real-time data and images.

For the full story, visit <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/90766/> 



vote for Young Indian Innovators who are Changing the World

In celebration of our independence this year, Digit has decided to compile a list of Young Indian Innovators who are Changing our World through tech. Whether a young Indian has designed a microchip, written an all-important algorithm for a search engine, or has contributed to rural enterprise, we would like to identify and felicitate the individual for his contribution to our society.

To help in the endeavour, we would like to enlist your help. Contribute to this cause by sending in your nominations to yii@thinkdigit.com, and by voting for those whose work you think has truly made an impact on India and the world. Take a moment of your time to show your appreciation for the great minds of contemporary India.

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